

# DIABETIC FOOT ASSESSMENT AND REFERRAL PATHWAY

Patient attends for foot examination/ assessment at diagnosis and / or annual review  
Examination to include:

- Testing for neuropathy with 10g monofilament (multiple sites)
- Palpation of foot pulses
- Inspection of foot deformity
- Inspection of footwear
- History of ulceration
- Footcare education

**Risk Status should be documented and the patient informed**

## Low Risk

Normal sensation & pulses palpable

Review annually by practice - include foot care education to improve knowledge and encourage self-care

[www.whittington.nhs.uk/Podiatry](http://www.whittington.nhs.uk/Podiatry)

## Moderate Risk

One risk factor e.g. loss of sensation or signs of PVD

### NO

Review by practice 1-3 mths according to need - include foot care education to improve knowledge and encourage self-care

Review annually or 3-6 mths by practice according to need include footcare education to improve knowledge and encourage self-care

If Podiatry required direct patient to [www.whittington.nhs.uk/podiatry](http://www.whittington.nhs.uk/podiatry) to self refer

## High Risk

Previous ulcer or amputation or more than one risk factor

Are any of the following present:

- Corn or callus
- Toe nail problems
- Structural deformity
- Poor vision
- On dialysis

### YES

Refer to Community Podiatry using EMIS GP podiatry referral form – Whittington

Lesion /problem resolved Podiatry to refer back to practice

Lesion/ problem resolved Podiatry to refer on

## Active

Presence of:

- New foot ulceration with cellulitis or infection
- Suspected osteomyelitis or ulceration probing to bone
- Suspected acute Charcot foot
- Necrosis or gangrene
- Chronic ulceration failing to improve

Refer immediately to Diabetic Foot MDT at Whittington Hospital on [mdtpodiatry.whitthealth@nhs.net](mailto:mdtpodiatry.whitthealth@nhs.net) In case of delay in referral, start antibiotics in accordance with local guidelines OR

Royal Free Hospital (RFH)  
**Hot Clinic:** Email: rf-tr.rfpodiatryfax@nhs.net

Tel: 020 78302749

Fax: 02074338884